

MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Advisory | Assurance | Tax | Consulting

SOC 2 Type II Examination Report

Summary for RFP Response Use

CONFIDENTIAL

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Meridian & Associates LLP | New York | Chicago | San Francisco | London | Singapore

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1. Report Overview

This document summarizes the results of Meridian & Associates LLP's System and Organization Controls (SOC 2) Type II examination for the period January 1, 2025 through December 31, 2025. The examination was conducted by Whitfield & Crane LLP, an independent CPA firm registered with the AICPA and specializing in SOC examinations.

Examination Period: January 1, 2025 - December 31, 2025

Report Date: February 15, 2026

Service Auditor: Whitfield & Crane LLP, New York, NY

Trust Service Criteria: Security, Availability, Confidentiality, Processing Integrity

Opinion: Unqualified (Clean)

Exceptions Noted: Zero (0)

2. Scope of Examination

The SOC 2 Type II examination covered Meridian's information systems, infrastructure, and operational processes supporting the delivery of professional services to clients. The scope encompasses the following systems and environments:

In-Scope Systems

- Meridian Client Portal (MCP) -- secure client document exchange and collaboration platform
- Meridian TaxConnect -- cloud-based global tax compliance management platform
- Meridian Insight -- data analytics and audit automation platform
- Meridian WorkStream -- engagement management and workflow platform
- Enterprise email and collaboration (Microsoft 365 E5 with Advanced Compliance)
- Document management system (iManage Work 10 Cloud)
- Financial reporting and audit workpaper systems (CaseWare Cloud, CCH Engagement)
- Corporate network infrastructure across 42 offices globally
- Azure and AWS cloud environments hosting client-facing applications
- Identity and access management (Okta Identity Cloud, CyberArk Privileged Access)

In-Scope Facilities

- Primary data center: Equinix NY5, Secaucus, NJ (Tier IV)
- Secondary data center: CyrusOne Sterling, VA (Tier III+)
- Azure regions: East US 2, West US 2, West Europe, Southeast Asia
- AWS regions: US-East-1, EU-West-1 (disaster recovery)
- Corporate headquarters: New York, NY (120 Meridian Plaza)
- Regional processing centers: Chicago, IL; London, UK; Singapore

3. Trust Service Criteria and Controls

3.1 Security

The Security criterion addresses the protection of information and systems against unauthorized access, both physical and logical. Meridian maintains a comprehensive security program governed by the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and the Information Security Steering Committee.

Key Controls Tested

- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) required for all user access to production systems, VPN, and client platforms
- Role-based access control (RBAC) with quarterly access reviews and automated deprovisioning within 24 hours of termination
- Network segmentation with micro-segmentation for client engagement environments
- Endpoint detection and response (EDR) on all managed devices with 24/7 SOC monitoring
- Vulnerability management program with monthly scans and critical patches applied within 72 hours
- Annual penetration testing by independent third party (NCC Group)
- Security awareness training with monthly phishing simulations (98.2% pass rate)
- Encrypted communications (TLS 1.3 for data in transit, AES-256 for data at rest)

3.2 Availability

The Availability criterion addresses whether systems are available for operation and use as committed or agreed. Meridian maintains published service-level objectives for all client-facing platforms.

Key Controls Tested

- 99.95% uptime SLO for client-facing platforms (actual achieved: 99.98% for 2025)
- Automated failover between primary and secondary data centers with RTO < 4 hours, RPO < 1 hour
- Comprehensive backup strategy: hourly incremental, daily full, with 90-day retention and geographic replication
- Annual disaster recovery testing with documented results (last test: October 2025, full recovery in 2.8 hours)
- Real-time infrastructure monitoring with automated alerting (PagerDuty) and documented escalation procedures
- Capacity planning reviews conducted quarterly with 12-month forecasting

3.3 Confidentiality

The Confidentiality criterion addresses the protection of information designated as confidential. Given the nature of professional services, Meridian handles extremely sensitive client data including financial records, tax returns, strategic plans, and personally identifiable information.

Key Controls Tested

- Data classification framework with four tiers: Public, Internal, Confidential, Highly Restricted
- Data loss prevention (DLP) controls on email, cloud storage, and endpoint devices
- Client data isolation through dedicated engagement workspaces with unique encryption keys

- Information barriers (ethical walls) for conflicted engagements with automated enforcement
- Secure data destruction with certificate of destruction for physical and electronic media
- Third-party risk management program with annual assessments of critical vendors
- Client confidentiality acknowledged in engagement letters and reinforced through annual firm-wide training

3.4 Processing Integrity

The Processing Integrity criterion addresses whether system processing is complete, valid, accurate, timely, and authorized.

Key Controls Tested

- Input validation controls on all client-facing data entry interfaces
- Automated reconciliation processes for financial data with exception reporting
- Change management process requiring peer review, testing, and approval before production deployment
- Segregation of duties between development, testing, and production environments
- Automated quality checks in tax compliance workflow (TaxConnect) with dual-review gates
- Audit trail logging for all data modifications with tamper-evident storage

4. Examination Results

Whitfield & Crane LLP tested 187 individual controls across the four Trust Service Criteria. The examination included inspection of documentation, observation of processes, re-performance of controls, and inquiry of responsible personnel.

Results Summary

Total Controls Tested: 187

Controls Operating Effectively: 187 (100%)

Exceptions Identified: 0

Management Assertions Supported: Yes, for all criteria

Opinion Type: Unqualified (Clean)

The service auditor concluded that Meridian & Associates LLP's controls were suitably designed and operating effectively throughout the examination period to provide reasonable assurance that Meridian's service commitments and system requirements were achieved based on the Trust Service Criteria.

5. Complementary User Entity Controls (CUECs)

The effectiveness of Meridian's controls also depends on certain controls being implemented and operated by client organizations (user entities). Key CUECs include:

- Clients are responsible for managing user access credentials and promptly notifying Meridian of personnel changes
- Clients should implement MFA for their own users accessing Meridian platforms
- Clients are responsible for the accuracy and completeness of data provided to Meridian
- Clients should maintain their own backup procedures for any data not stored on Meridian platforms
- Clients should promptly report any suspected security incidents to Meridian's Security Operations Center

6. Bridge Letter and Continuous Monitoring

Meridian maintains a continuous monitoring program between SOC 2 examination periods. Key elements include monthly security metrics reporting to the CISO, quarterly internal control self-assessments, and continuous automated monitoring of critical controls through our GRC platform (ServiceNow GRC).

A bridge letter covering the period from January 1, 2026 to the date of inquiry is available upon request. The bridge letter is signed by Meridian's CISO and attests that no material changes have been made to the control environment and no exceptions have been identified since the last examination period.

For a complete copy of the SOC 2 Type II report, including the detailed description of the system, the service auditor's tests of controls, and the results of those tests, please contact the Meridian & Associates LLP Risk Management Office at soc2@meridian-llp.com. Distribution requires execution of a non-disclosure agreement.